

The Google Business Profile Checklist for Professional & Trade Services

25 things to fix on your Google listing so enquiries come direct — not via hipages.

hipages, Airtasker and Oneflare charge you \$20–50 per lead — and most of those leads come from people who never even meant to be on those platforms. They Googled "[your trade] near [their town]," clicked an ad, and got dumped into a directory you're now paying to bid in.

Your Google Business Profile is the single biggest free tool you have to capture those enquiries direct. This checklist fixes the bits most trades and pros get wrong. Takes about an hour. Print it, tick each box as you go.

1. Foundation

THE BASICS — GET THESE WRONG AND NOTHING ELSE MATTERS

☐ Claim and verify your listing

If Google doesn't trust you own the business, you can't edit anything. Search your business name on Google and look for "Own this business?"

☐ Business name matches your real registered name

No keyword stuffing. "Smith Plumbing Best Plumber Bairnsdale" gets you suspended. Just your actual business name — the one on your invoices.

☐ Service-area set correctly (hide the street address if you go to clients)

If you run from home or a van and visit clients on-site, hide the street address and list service areas instead. Google supports "service-area business" mode — tradies and consultants should use it.

☐ Phone number is the one you actually answer

Not a hipages forwarding number, not an answering service that lets enquiries go cold. Your mobile, which you check between jobs.

☐ Website link points to your own site

Your own domain, your own quote form. Not your hipages profile, not your Airtasker page — those are sending Google traffic to lead-resale platforms.

2. Categories & Attributes

TELL GOOGLE EXACTLY WHAT YOU DO

- ☐ **Primary category as specific as possible**
"Plumber," "Electrician," "Accountant," "Family lawyer," "Bookkeeper," "Marketing consultant" — pick the most specific. "Electrician" beats "Contractor" every time.
 - ☐ **Add 2–4 secondary categories**
"Hot-water-system supplier," "Solar-installation contractor," "Tax preparation service," "Conveyancer" if they apply. Don't pad with stuff you don't actually do.
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- ☐ **Tick service attributes — including "free quotes" + "online appointments"**
Online appointments, onsite services, free quotes, accepts new clients, wheelchair-accessible. Clients filter by these and they trigger trust badges on your listing.

3. Services, Service Area & Credentials

WHAT YOU DO, WHERE YOU DO IT, WHY THEY CAN TRUST YOU

- ☐ **Every service listed under "Services" with a one-line description**
In your GBP dashboard, add every distinct service ("Hot water repairs," "Solar installation," "BAS prep," "Wills"). Each one becomes a search-match. Most pros leave this blank — this is the #1 missed lever.
 - ☐ **Service areas list every town you actually serve**
Bairnsdale, Lakes Entrance, Paynesville, Sale — whatever you cover. Don't claim Melbourne if you don't drive there. Honest coverage helps you rank in those towns.
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- ☐ **Licences, ABN and credentials mentioned in the description**
"Licensed plumber, REC 12345" / "CPA-registered" / "Master Builder member." Use the full 750-character description to list cred + years in business + service area. This is your trust block.

4. Photos

PHOTOS OF YOUR WORK BEAT STOCK SHOTS EVERY TIME

- ☐ **A real headshot of you (and your team if you have one)**
Trades and pros sell trust. A photo of an actual human in the work uniform beats a stock photo of a clipboard. Daylight, friendly, no awkward studio backdrops.
 - ☐ **Completed-work photos — before/after where it makes sense**
Tradies: before/after shots of the install, the renovation, the repair. Pros: photos of meetings, your office, signed cases. Show outcomes, not stock imagery.
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☐ **Premises or branded vehicle, refreshed monthly**

Your office or your branded ute / van — locals recognise the brand on the road. Add a fresh photo at least monthly (a new job, a new tool, a community sponsorship); Google rewards active listings.

5. Direct Enquiries vs Per-Lead Directories

WHERE THE \$20-50 PER LEAD SAVINGS ACTUALLY HAPPEN

☐ **"Get a quote" link goes to your own quote form**

In the GBP dashboard, set the "Quote" or "Appointments" link to your own quote form — not hipages, not Airtasker. Even a simple "Call to discuss" tel: link beats sending Google traffic to a lead-resale platform.

☐ **Online appointment booking turned on**

Tradies and consultants who can offer a self-serve booking calendar (Calendly, SimplyBook, your own widget) get a "Book online" button on their listing. Big conversion win on mobile.

☐ **Messaging turned on (and someone's watching it)**

Lets prospects text you from search to ask "do you cover Paynesville?" or "how soon could you come out?" Big trust signal. Reply within an hour during business hours.

Why this matters

hipages and Airtasker make money by selling the SAME lead to multiple tradies. Every dollar you pay them is a dollar you're paying to compete with three of your competitors for one job. Capture that enquiry on GBP and you're the only quote in the inbox.

6. Reviews, Posts & Q&A

THE ONGOING WORK THAT KEEPS YOU AHEAD OF QUIETER COMPETITORS

☐ **Reply to every review — good and bad**

Within 48 hours. By name, personalised, never copy-paste. A polite, professional reply to a 2-star wins more new clients than the bad review costs.

☐ **Ask for the review the day the job's done (or the invoice is paid)**

A text with your Google review link the day you finish. Or attach the link to your invoice email. Aim for one new review per week minimum — review velocity is the local-SEO multiplier.

☐ **Get your short Google review link**

In your GBP dashboard, click "Ask for reviews" — copy that short link, save it as a phone shortcut, paste it on invoices and follow-up texts.

☐ **Post an update every 2–4 weeks**

A completed job, a new service, a price change announcement, a seasonal reminder ("book your AC service before summer"). Counts as a fresh signal and shows up in your listing.

☐ **Pre-load the Q&A section**

Add the questions clients actually ask — do you quote free, how soon can you come, what areas do you cover, what payment methods — and answer them yourself. Saves you replying 50 times.

Done it all? Here's what's next.

If you've ticked every box, your Google Business Profile is now in better shape than 95% of tradies and pros in your town. Want a hand keeping enquiries coming straight to you instead of through hipages? Get in touch — find me on Facebook or Instagram as Your Mate Agency, or my email and number are right below.

Your Mate Agency — helping regional businesses get found online.

Built by Matt Rowlands in Mallacoota, East Gippsland.

matt@yourmateagency.com.au · 0478 101 521 · yourmateagency.com.au